

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Security Operations Centre Specialist | SIEM, Detection and Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) environments, delivering early threat detection, rapid incident response, and sustained cyber risk reduction. I have strong hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), including Kusto Query Language (KQL) query development, analytics rule tuning, and data connector configuration, alongside CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint detection and response and the full Microsoft Defender suite. I am experienced translating cyber risk, regulatory, and business requirements into practical, measurable, and operationally sustainable security controls. I bring a thorough understanding of IT infrastructure and networking, and I am confident working in environments that span both Information Technology (IT) and Operational Technology (OT) systems.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language/KQL query development, analytics rules, data connectors, alert tuning, workbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk/Security Processing Language (SPL)
- **Security Operations Centre (SOC) and Incident Response:** Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert triage, investigation and escalation, incident lifecycle management (NIST SP 800-61), root cause analysis, containment and remediation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent/Insight/Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework-based threat hunting, detection engineering, detection rule development and tuning, threat intelligence integration
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, vulnerability prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email security, network monitoring, Microsoft Intune/Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer | University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead Security Operations Centre (SOC) monitoring, analysis, and response activities, translating cyber risk and business demands into practical, measurable security controls that reduce organisational exposure.
- Engineer and maintain detection capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, writing and tuning Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, configuring data connectors, and maintaining workbooks to provide visibility across cloud, endpoint, identity, and network data sources.
- Conduct alert triage and advanced security incident investigations, performing root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation coordinated across Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR).

- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, and Next-Generation SIEM modules) for endpoint threat detection and continuous monitoring, ensuring complete coverage across the enterprise estate.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender, configuring detection policies and coordinating cross-platform response actions.
- Perform threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework gap analysis and threat intelligence, converting findings directly into new detection rules or tuning recommendations in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Manage identity and access security via Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID, including Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) configuration.
- Implement and maintain BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control privileged access across IT infrastructure and reduce the attack surface from credential-based threats.
- Drive vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, ensuring identified risks are tracked to remediation and reported in line with risk appetite.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell and Sentinel automation rules, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for recurring threat scenarios.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity | University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

- Operated as a Tier 2 and Tier 3 SOC analyst, investigating security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon, producing incident reports and escalating to senior stakeholders as required.
- Wrote and tuned KQL detection queries in Microsoft Sentinel, systematically reducing false positive rates and improving detection coverage across cloud, identity, and endpoint sources.
- Managed Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID identity security, designing and deploying Conditional Access policies, enforcing Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and reviewing Identity Protection risk events.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent endpoint protection across the estate, managing prevention policies, investigating detections, and coordinating endpoint isolation for confirmed incidents.
- Supported the implementation of BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), reducing privileged account exposure across Windows Server and cloud workloads.
- Maintained Mimecast email security controls, including anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, URL filtering, and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policies.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance programmes, providing technical evidence and supporting external audit activities.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure | HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls across a cloud-based Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, maintaining compliance with ISO 27001 and CIS Controls frameworks.
- Managed endpoint security and device compliance via Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management/Mobile Application Management) and Azure Active Directory, enforcing security baselines across a distributed workforce.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, tracking findings to remediation and providing risk posture reporting to management.
- Delivered PowerShell scripting automation to improve consistency and efficiency across security operations and infrastructure management tasks.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an estate of over 8,000 users, standardising SOC visibility across endpoint and identity and significantly reducing mean time to detect (MTTD).
- Engineered a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, systematically improving SOC detection coverage and reducing false positive rates.

- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon across a complex enterprise environment, integrating Next-Generation SIEM telemetry with Microsoft Sentinel to provide unified visibility across endpoint, cloud, and identity.
 - Developed automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for common threat scenarios, enabling consistent, repeatable containment without manual analyst intervention.
 - Established a structured threat hunting programme using MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, resulting in multiple detections converted into permanent analytics rules and sustained reduction in undetected attacker dwell time.
 - Delivered technical evidence for successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification across endpoint, identity, patching, and network boundary controls.
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EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Environmental and Resource Engineering
 - Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in Chemical Engineering
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CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (UK)